



Creator Experts.

A high-friction labor market. Where AI compounds.

Sourcing. Verification. Evaluation. Outcome prediction.

For Aaron Langerman, Strategic Ops.

Logan Mann + Aarnav Nagabhirava

On Mercor's CUA-envs contract for Anthropic, under Drew Geoly.

THE BROKEN WORKFLOW.

Five steps. Most of them manual. None of them scale.

01

Brand brief

marketing manager opens a doc

02

DM agents

searches IG/TikTok DMs

03

Manual scroll

opens 40 profiles, evaluates by eye

04

Email volley

3–5 round-trips per creator

05

Sign or pass

guess at fit, sign contract, hope

70%

of brands say finding the right creators is their biggest bottleneck.

Aspire, State of Influencer Marketing 2025.

39%

of brands still rely on manual research.

IMH/Sprout Q1 2025 Pulse.

WHY NOW.

Three forces just shifted under the creator market.

01 Manual review doesn't scale when content explodes.

YouTube enforcement, Jan 2026: 16 channels removed, 35M subs, 4.7B views erased (Neal Mohan, 2026-01-12).

02 AI slop has flooded the feed.

Only 26% of consumers prefer AI-generated creator content today, down from 60% in 2023 (Billion Dollar Boy Muse Two, 2025-11-20). Brands need a way to filter slop from real signal.

03 Ad costs are climbing.

Meta Q3 2025: +10% YoY price-per-ad, "increased advertiser demand" (Susan Li, 2025-10-29).



SIGNAL.

Pay for proof, not for follower count.

68% of brand-creator contracts include performance metrics — up from 42% in 2023.
Lumanu \$1B+ payouts dataset, 2025.

DIMENSION	INDUSTRY DEFAULT	MERCOR CREATOR DOMAIN
Ranking input	Follower count	Outcome history × niche fit
Trust check	Self-declared	Handle + post-fingerprint verified
Pricing	Flat per post	Placement on close + perf kicker
THE MOAT	—	Predictor delta vs follower-baseline +18%, 90d

VERIFICATION.

Four checks to filter the fakes.

01

Handle ownership

TikTok/IG handle resolves to a live profile with matching display name.

02

Fingerprint

Recent post timestamps + caption style confirm consistent authorship.

03

Niche claim

Self-declared tags vs last 30 posts. Manual review for v1.

MANUAL REVIEW FOR V1

04

Audience truth

Sampled audience demographics check. Manual review for v1.

MANUAL REVIEW FOR V1

37.2%

of influencer followers are fake/inauthentic. ~\$4.6B/yr brand waste.

SociaVault 100K-account audit, 2025.

55%

of Instagram influencers have engaged in fraudulent activity.

HypeAuditor State of Influencer Marketing 2024.

\$53,088

FTC max civil penalty per violation (Final Rule, eff. 2024-10-21).

Federal Register, 2024.

DAY-1 REVENUE.

Three revenue lines. One signed deal.

a

Placement fee on close

20% × \$850 base contract.
Headhunter contingent benchmark.

\$170

b

Performance kicker (per-post)

5% of view-bonus pool.
Lumanu pattern.

\$0–\$50

c

RL data licensing

Outcome data + rubric scores feed Mercor's existing human-data market for RL environments.
Illustrative — flagged in deck.

Per task

Logan × Celsius signed: \$170 placement + \$0–\$50 perf kicker + per-task RL revenue when this becomes a Mercor world.



PROVE BY AUGUST.

Four proof points. Falsifiable. By August.

01

Workflow pain real

10 brand interviews. Quantify per-creator review time.

02

Verification works

1,000 creators screened. Catch rate vs ground truth.

03

Quality scoring beats baseline

Mercor model vs follower-count, on 5 brands.

04

Outcome prediction holds

Predicted vs actual on 10 finished campaigns.

4 of 4 → strategic adjacency. 2 of 4 → kill it.

Paid like a headhunter. Placement on signed deals.



NOW → LIVE DEMO

The demo's the rest of the pitch.

Logan as a creator — real 22.7K TikTok account, applying inside Mercor's stepper.

Aaron as Mercor admin — RAG cites real posts back by URL, outreach drafts in line.

Live: musing-maxwell-84ed29.vercel.app